

SMART
CHARGING

Consumer Preferences for BEV Smart Charging Programs

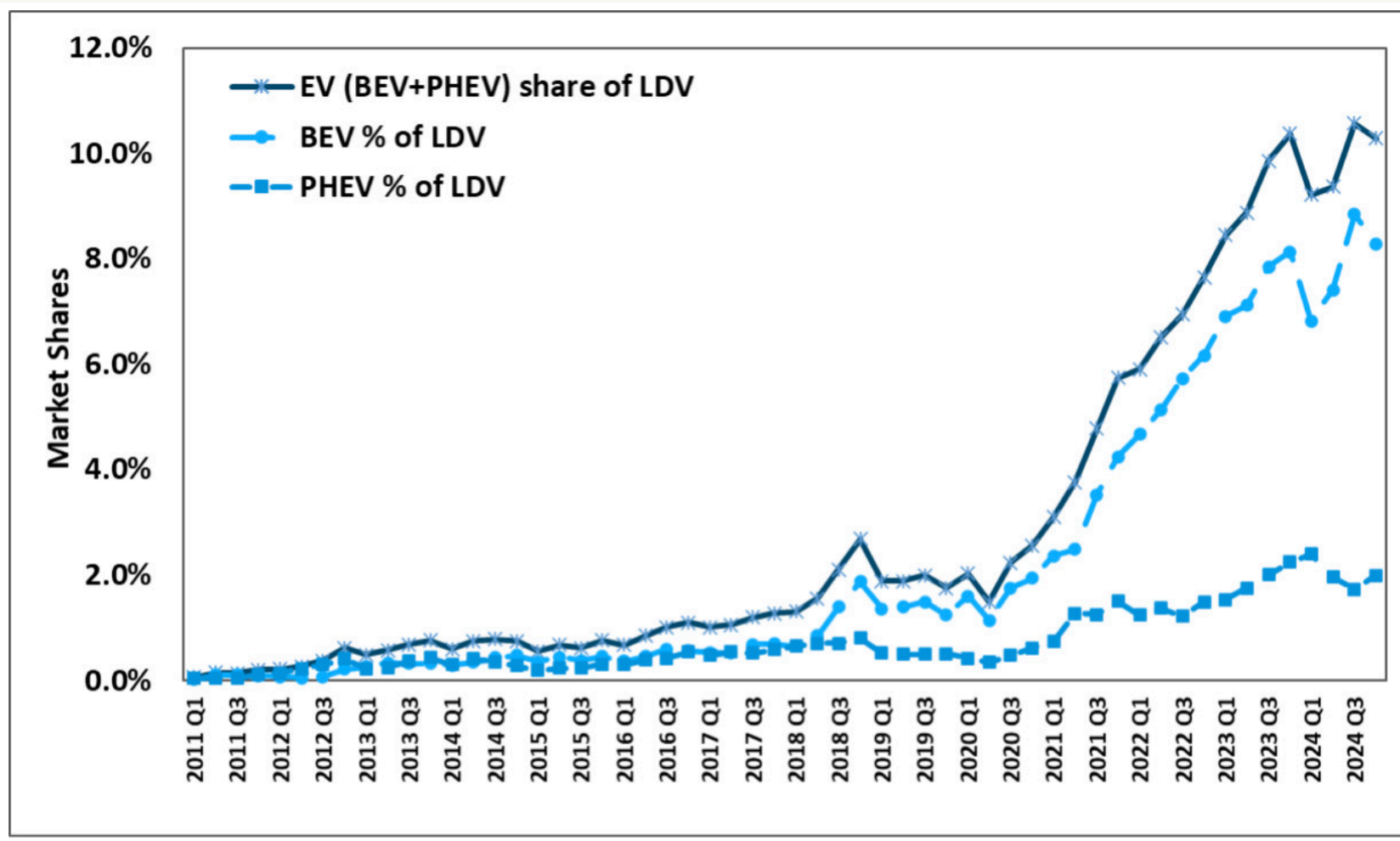
DQE Part II 2025

Funded by the Alfred P. Sloan Foundation

Pingfan Hu



EV sales in US reaching ~10% of sales

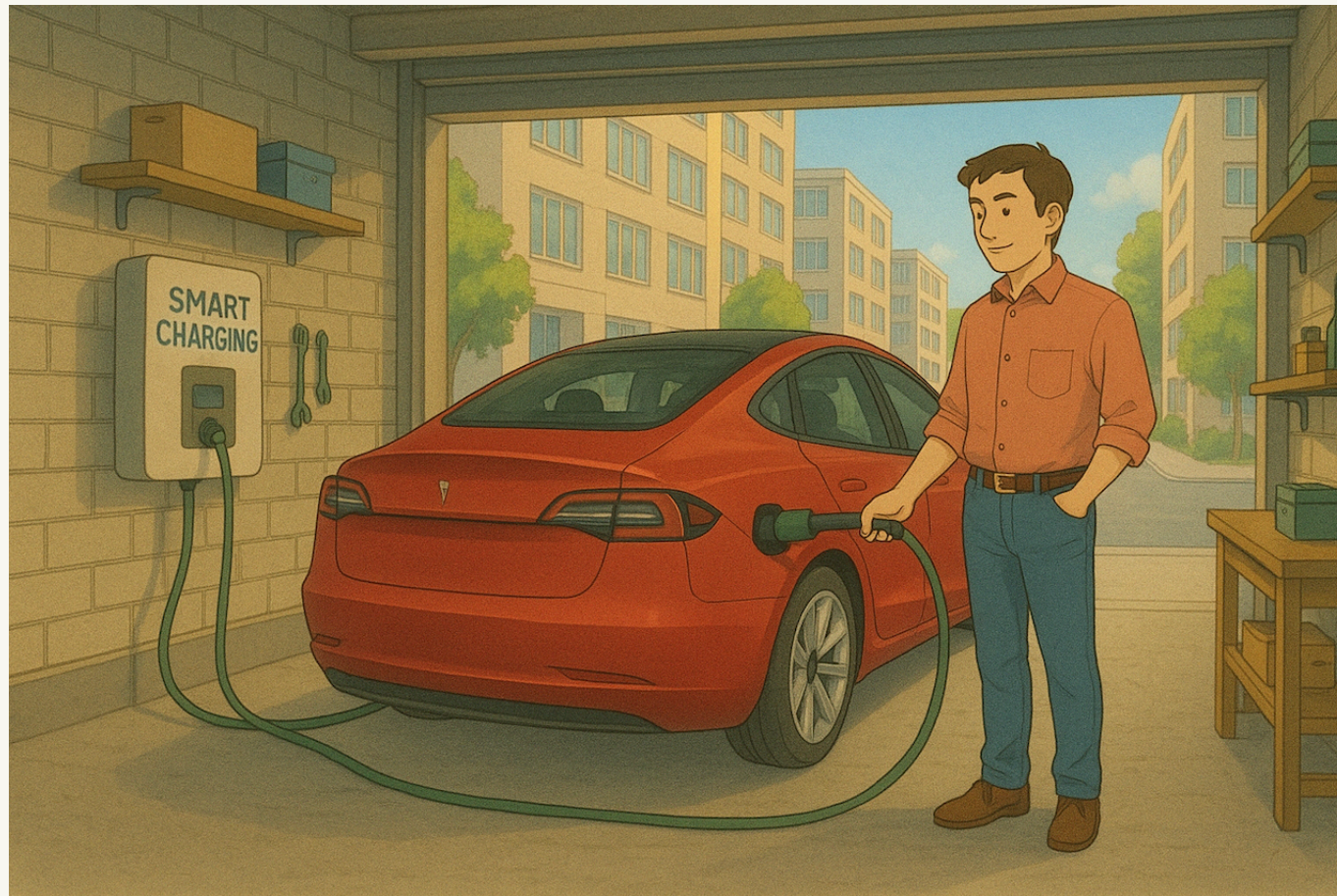


Source: Argonne National Lab, www.anl.gov/ev-facts/model-sales



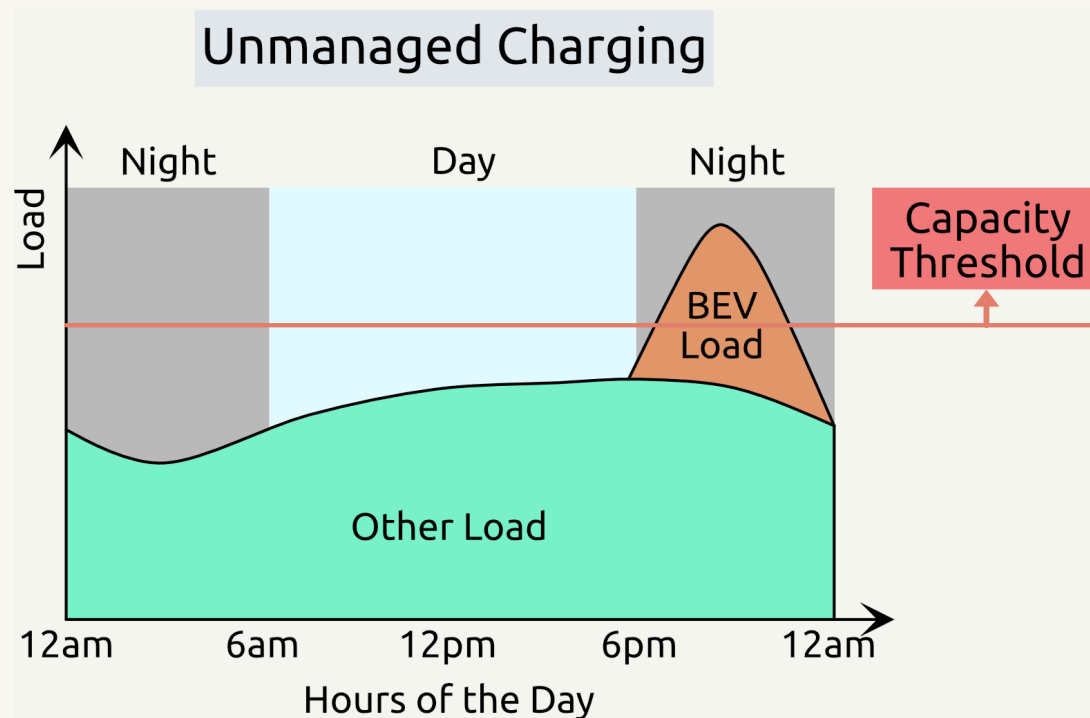
Introduction

- **Unmanaged** BEV charging is becoming a problem to the grid.
- **Managed** charging is cheaper and smoothes out the grid load.
- **Smart** charging: Supplier-Managed Charging (SMC) and Vehicle-to-Grid (V2G).



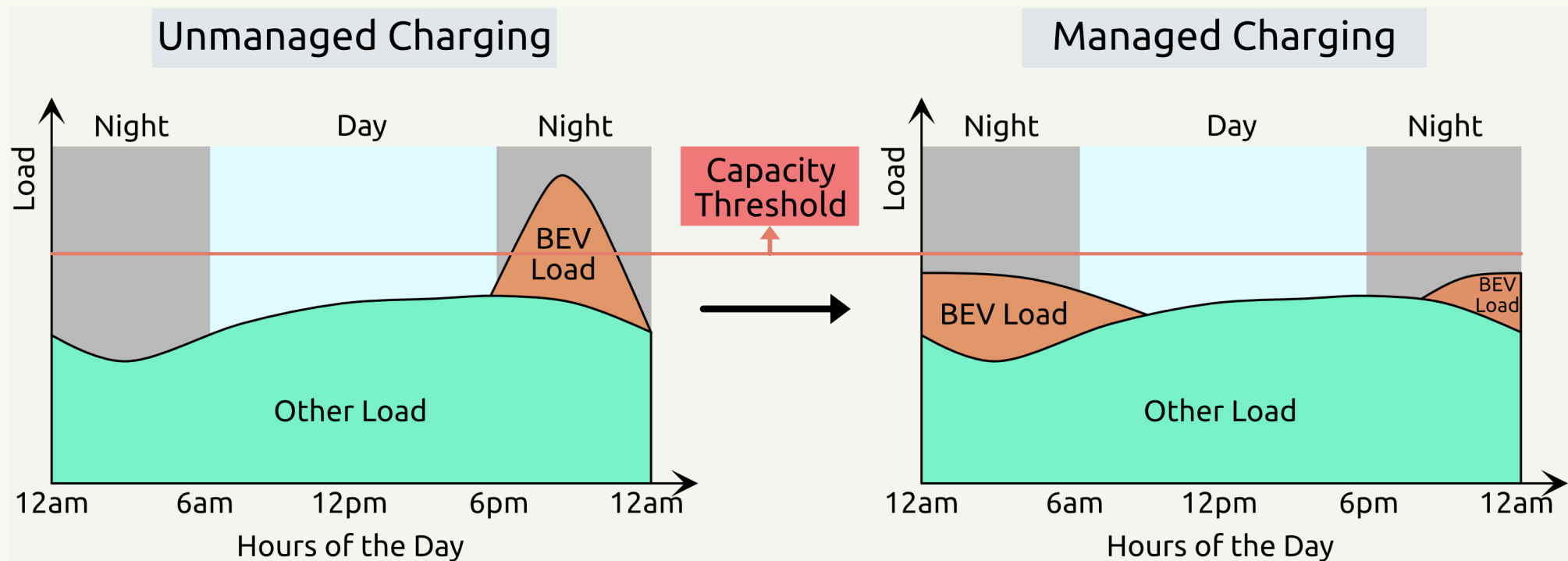
SMC - Supplier Managed Charging

- SMC smooths out overnight EV charging demand.
- Electricity demand is controlled below capacity threshold.
- It saves money and reduces pollution.



SMC - Supplier Managed Charging

- SMC smooths out overnight EV charging demand.
- Electricity demand is controlled below capacity threshold.
- It saves money and reduces pollution.



Managed charging avoids overload caused by BEV charging.



V2G - Vehicle-to-Grid

Non-V2G (Single Direction)

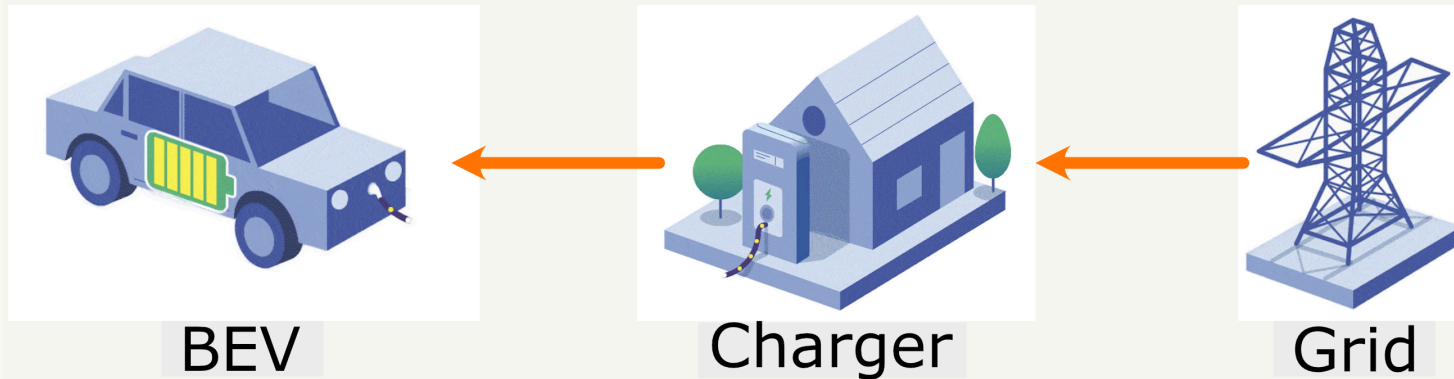
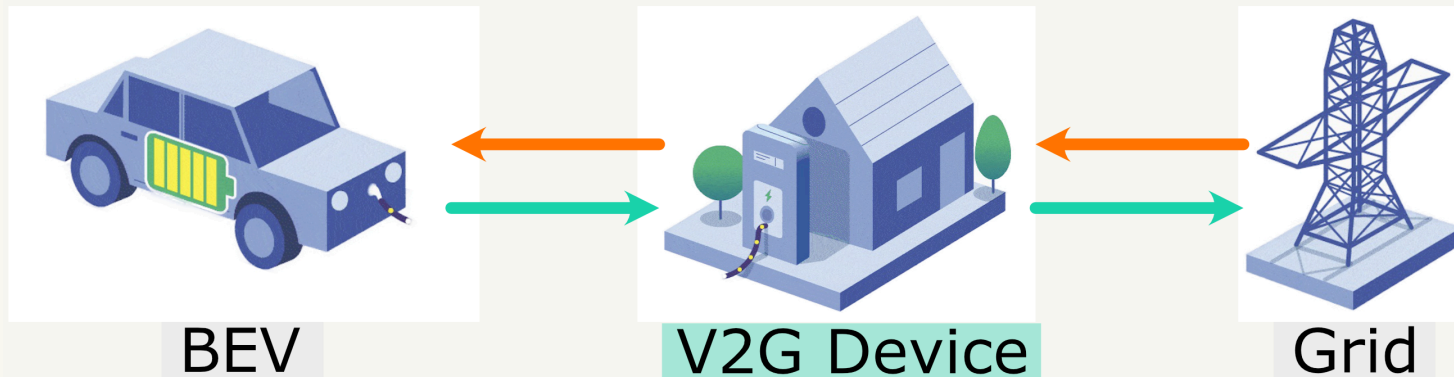


Figure Source: wri.org

V2G (Bi-direction)



In a V2G event, BEVs can charge the grid when necessary. BEVs are charged back eventually. Owners earn money.



Smart charging depends on enrollment.



Literature Review

1. A study by Wong et al. (2023) examined **incentives** affect the EV owners' acceptance, **but EV ownership is only 19%**.
2. A study by Philip and Whitehead (2024) found **range anxiety** matters, **but EV ownership is only 1.28%**.
3. Another study by Huang et al. (2021) indicates the importance of **fast charging**, **but the sample size is only 157**.

None of them have demographics data to study **heterogeneity**.

We need high EV ownership & large sample size, and consider heterogeneity.



Research Questions

1. **Sensitivity:** How do changes in smart charging program features influence BEV owners' willingness to opt in?
2. **Enrollment Rate:** Under what **combinations of features** will BEV owners be more willing to opt in to smart charging programs?

Conjoint survey to collect BEV owners' willingness.

Multinomial logit model for utility simulations.



Survey Design with formr

Conjoint Questions

1. Monetary Incentives
2. Charging Limitations
3. Flexibility

Demographic Questions

1. BEV Ownership
2. Personal Info
3. Household Info



Conjoint Question Explained

A Sample Conjoint Question

For example, if these were the only apples available, which would you choose? *

Option 1	Option 2	Option 3
		
Type: Fuji	Type: Pink Lady	Type: Honeycrisp
Price: \$ 2 / lb	Price: \$ 1.5 / lb	Price: \$ 2 / lb
Freshness: Average	Freshness: Excellent	Freshness: Poor

1. Provide respondents with different **sets** of attributes.
2. Observe choices across random sets.
3. Estimate **utility** of each attribute.



SMC Programs

Attributes

No.	Attributes	Range
1	Enrollment Cash	\$50 to \$300
2	Monthly Cash	\$2 to \$20
3	Monthly Override	0 to 5
4	Min Battery	20% to 40%
5	Guaranteed Battery	60% to 80%

Sample Program

Attributes	Values
Enrollment Cash	\$300
Monthly Cash	\$20
Monthly Override	5
Min Guaranteed 0 80 160 200 miles	
(Range determined by stated vehicle they own)	



V2G Programs

Attributes

No.	Attributes	Range
1	Enrollment Cash	\$50 to \$300
2	Occurrence Cash	\$2 to \$20
3	Monthly Occurrence	1 to 4
4	Lower Bound	20% to 40%
5	Guaranteed Battery	60% to 80%

Sample Program

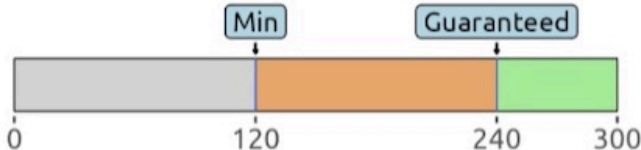
Attributes	Values
Enrollment Cash	\$300
Occurrence Cash	\$20
Monthly Occurrence	1
Low Guaranteed 0 80 160 200 miles	
(Range determined by stated vehicle they own)	



Sample SMC Question

(1 of 6) If your utility offers you these 2 SMC programs, which one do you prefer?
(Your BEV has maximum range of **300** miles.)

[Access the SMC Attributes](#)

Option 1	Option 2	Option 3
Enrollment Cash: \$100 Monthly Cash: \$20 Override Allowance: 1 per Month Battery Thresholds (in Miles):  A horizontal bar representing a 300-mile range. It is divided into three segments: a grey segment from 0 to 60 miles, an orange segment from 60 to 240 miles, and a green segment from 240 to 300 miles. Above the bar, a blue box labeled 'Min' points to the 60-mile mark, and another blue box labeled 'Guaranteed' points to the 240-mile mark.	Enrollment Cash: \$200 Monthly Cash: \$10 Override Allowance: 1 per Month Battery Thresholds (in Miles):  A horizontal bar representing a 300-mile range. It is divided into three segments: a grey segment from 0 to 120 miles, an orange segment from 120 to 240 miles, and a green segment from 240 to 300 miles. Above the bar, a blue box labeled 'Min' points to the 120-mile mark, and another blue box labeled 'Guaranteed' points to the 240-mile mark.	Not Interested



Sample V2G Question

(1 of 6) If your utility offers you these 2 V2G programs, which one do you prefer?
(Your BEV has maximum range of **300** miles.)

[Access the V2G Attributes](#)

Option 1	Option 2	Option 3
Enrollment Cash: \$100 Occurrence Cash: \$5 Monthly Occurrence: 2 Battery Thresholds (in Miles):  A horizontal bar representing a 300-mile range. The bar is divided into three segments: grey (0-90 miles), orange (90-210 miles), and green (210-300 miles). A blue box labeled 'Low' points to the 90-mile mark, and a blue box labeled 'Guaranteed' points to the 210-mile mark.	Enrollment Cash: \$100 Occurrence Cash: \$20 Monthly Occurrence: 2 Battery Thresholds (in Miles):  A horizontal bar representing a 300-mile range. The bar is divided into three segments: grey (0-120 miles), orange (120-180 miles), and green (180-300 miles). A blue box labeled 'Low' points to the 120-mile mark, and a blue box labeled 'Guaranteed' points to the 180-mile mark.	Not Interested



Survey Fielding - 1356 in Total



Meta Ads: Voluntary participants

- 803 responses
- March to July in 2024

Dynata Recruitment: Paid survey

- 553 responses
- September to November in 2024



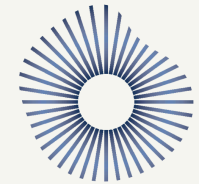
Facebook



Messenger



Instagram



dynata



Survey Question - Car Ownership

Car Ownership

1. What is your ZIP code?

22180

2. How many cars do you have?

☐ 1

☒ 2

☐ 3

☐ 4

☐ 5 or more

3. What is the **make** of your primary car?

3.1 What is the **model** of your primary car?

4. What is the **model year** of your primary car?

5. What is the **make** of your secondary car?

5.1 What is the **model** of your secondary car?

6. What is the **model year** of your secondary car?

Next Page

Other

✓ Acura

Alfa Romeo

Aston Martin

Audi

Bentley

BMW

Bugatti

Buick

Cadillac

Chevrolet

Chrysler

Daewoo

Dodge

Ferrari

FIAT

Fisker

Ford

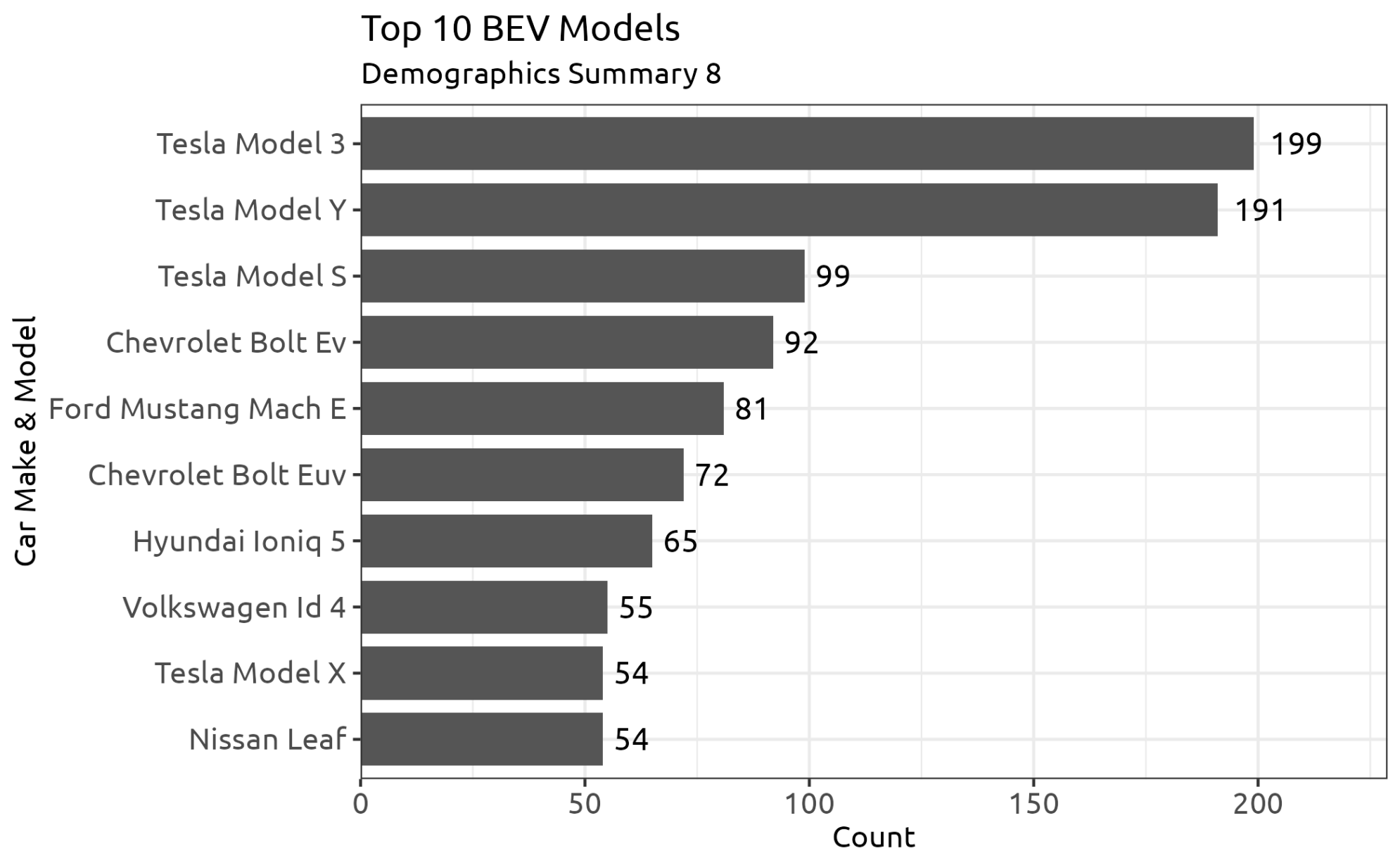
Genesis

GMC

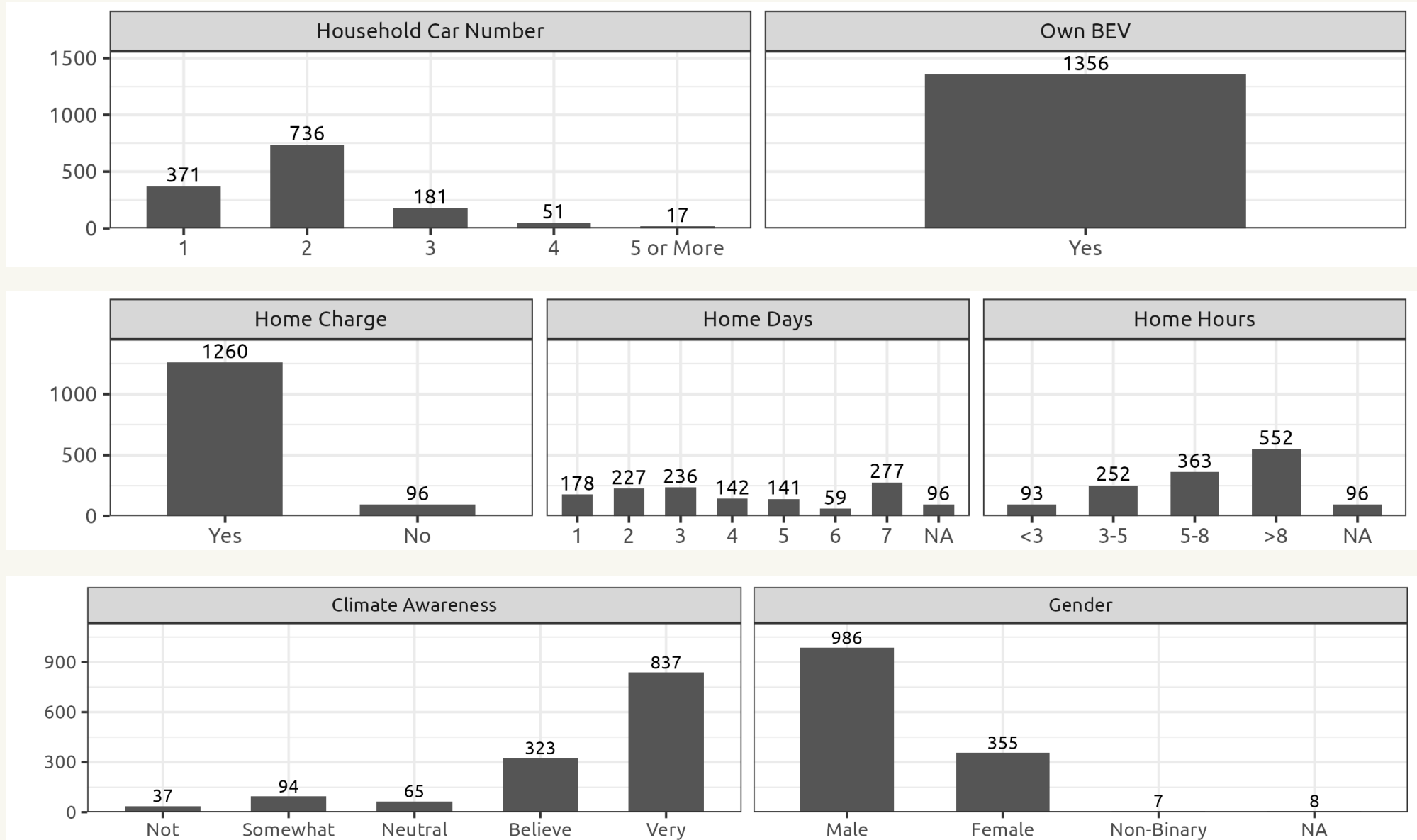
Honda



Survey Results - Top 10 BEV



Survey Results - Demographics



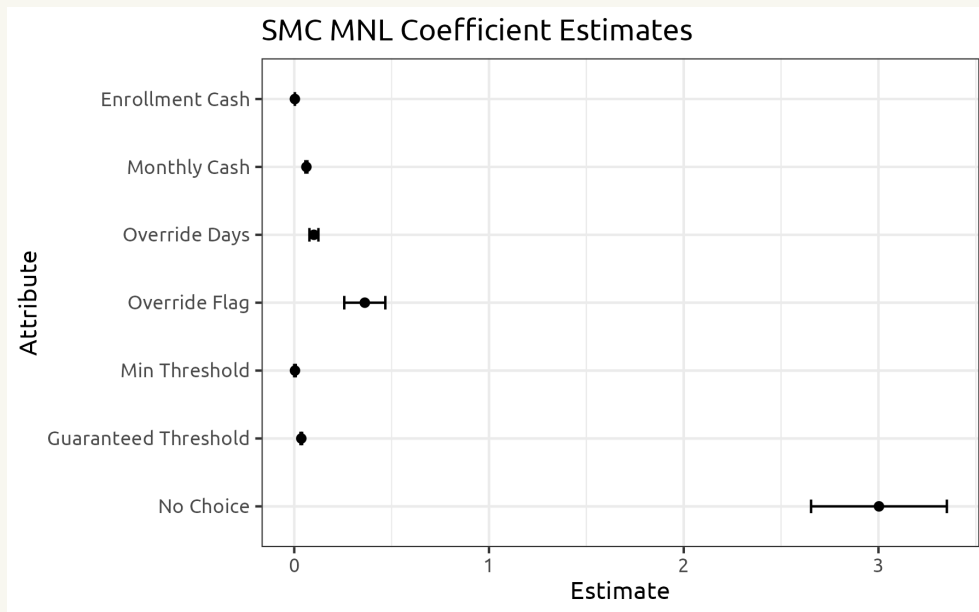
Survey Results - Willingness to Participate

Multinomial Logit Models

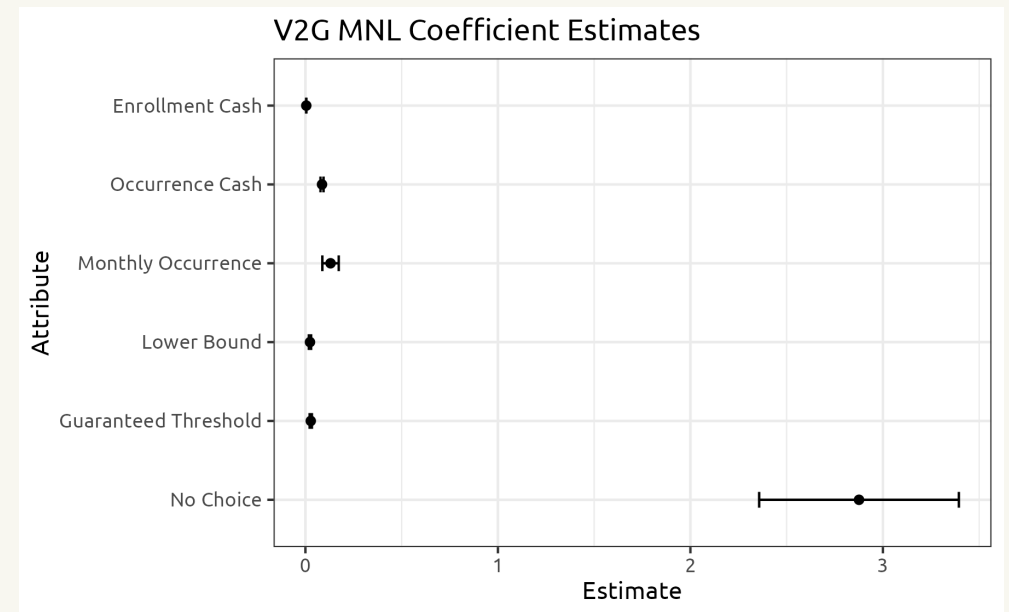
$$u_j = v_j + \epsilon_j = \beta'x + \epsilon_j \quad P_j = \frac{e^{v_j}}{\sum_{k=1}^J e^{v_k}}$$

Utility estimated using maximum likelihood estimation (MLE).

SMC Estimates



V2G Estimates



Without compensation, users will not participate.



Enrollment Sensitivity

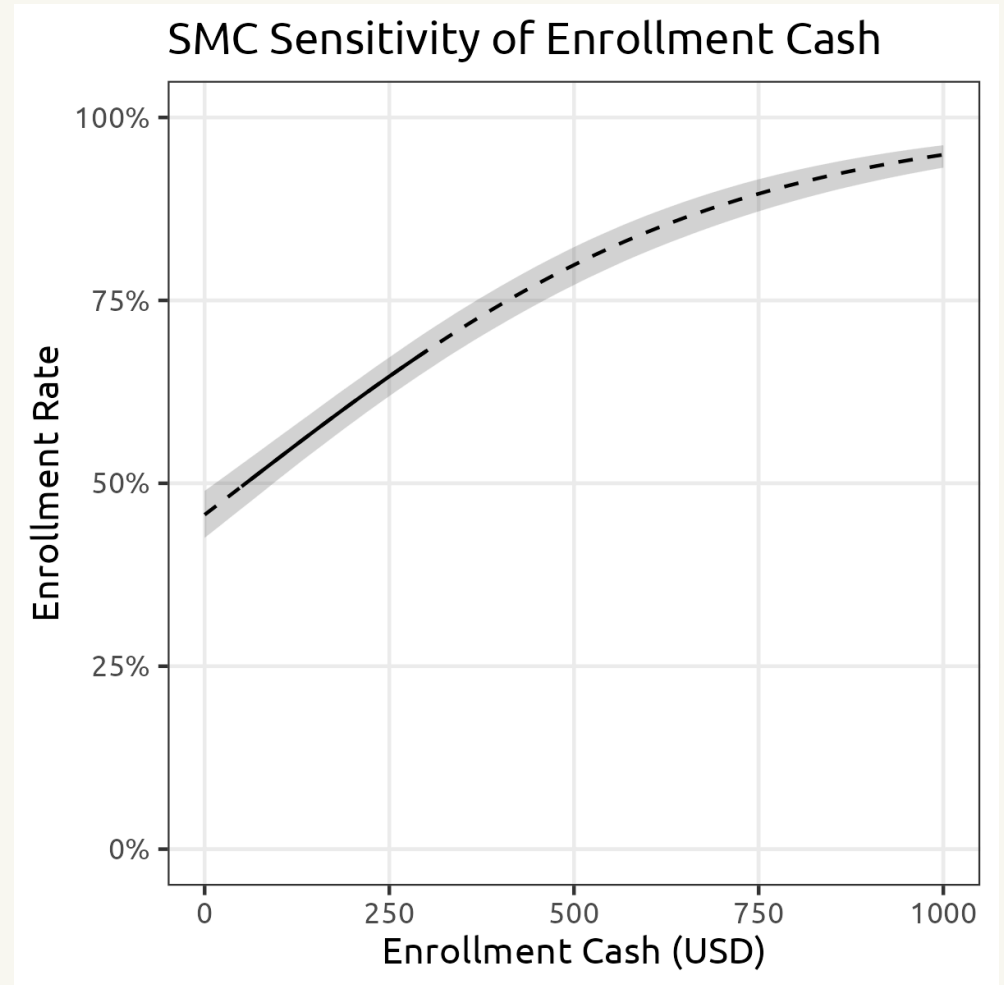
Baseline Simulation

Choice between “None” and this program:

Attributes	Values
Enrollment Cash	\$0 - \$1000
Monthly Cash	\$2
Monthly Override	1

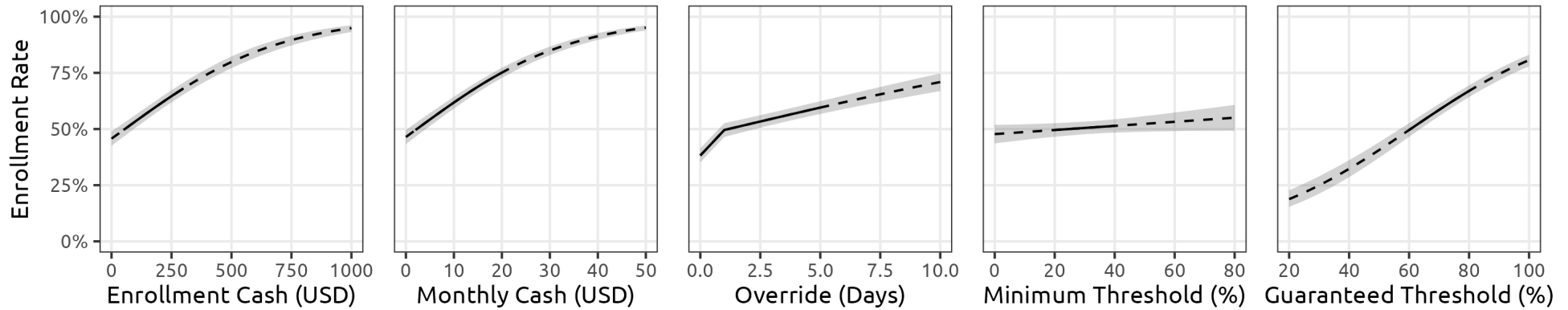
0 40 120 200 miles

Sensitivity Plot

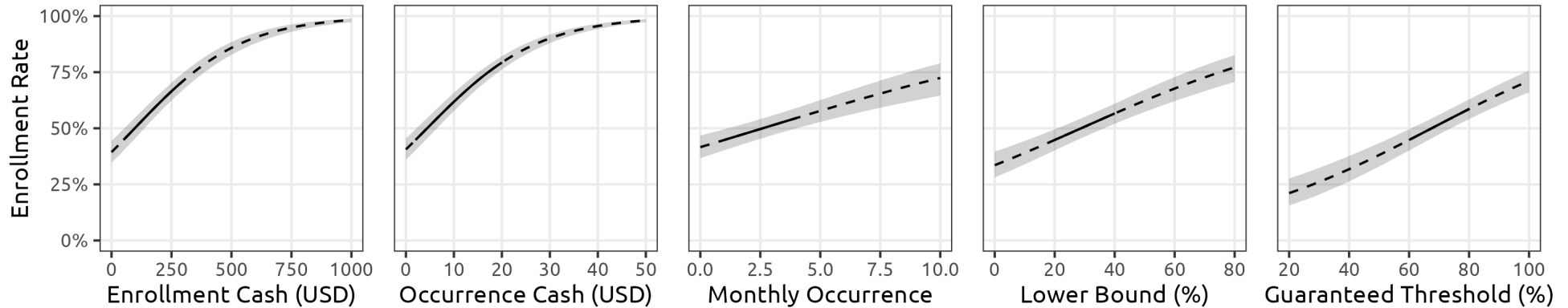


Enrollment Sensitivity

A) Supplier Managed Charging (SMC)



B) Vehicle-to-Grid (V2G)



1. Steeper slope indicates higher sensitivity.
2. Diminishing returns exist.



Equivalencies of 5% Enrollment Increase

SMC

Attribute	Equivalence Value	Unit
Enrollment Cash	64.7	\$
Monthly Cash	3.2	\$
Override Days	2.0	Days
Minimum Threshold	54.8	%
Guaranteed Threshold	5.5	%

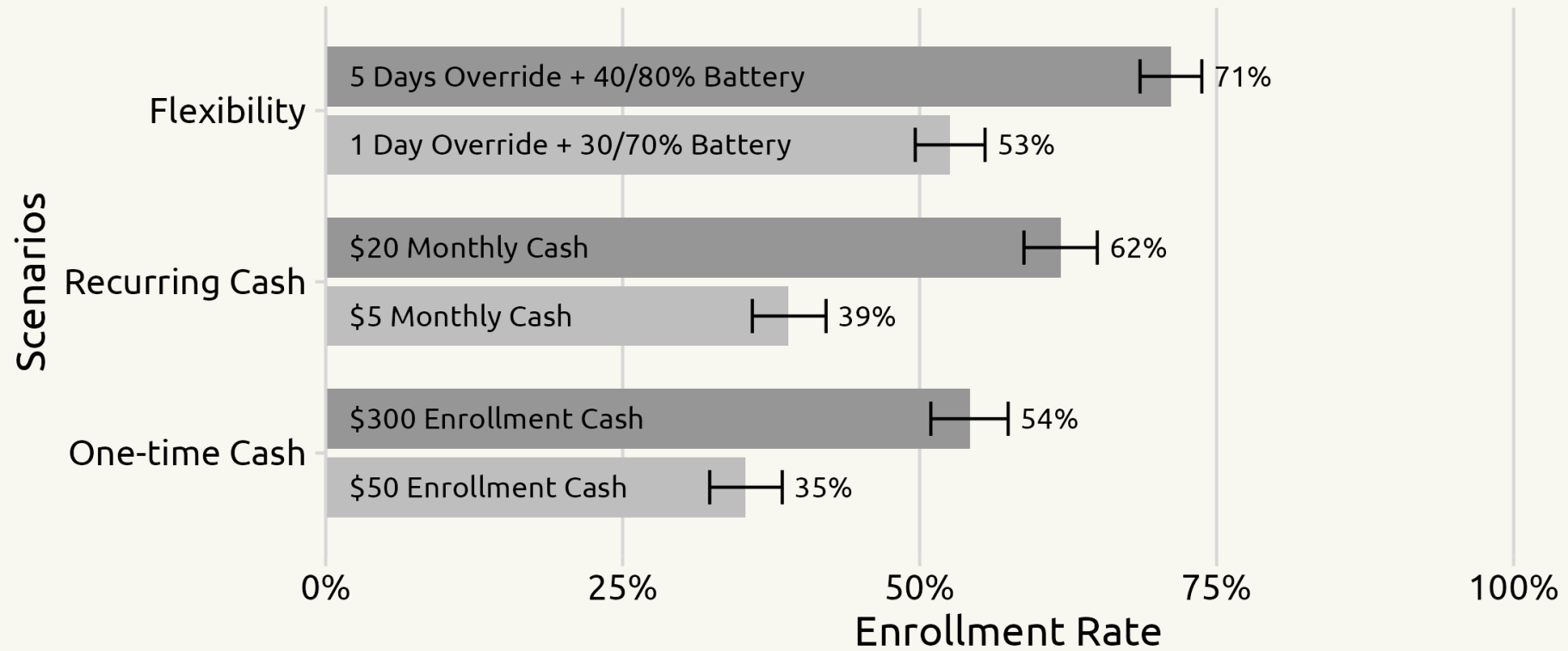
V2G

Attribute	Equivalence Value	Unit
Enrollment Cash	45.0	\$
Occurrence Cash	2.3	\$
Monthly Occurrence	1.5	Times
Lower Bound	8.5	%
Guaranteed Threshold	7.2	%

1. **Smaller** value indicates higher efficiency.
2. **Monetary** incentives are valued more in V2G than SMC.
3. **Guaranteed** threshold is more important in SMC than V2G, indicating range anxiety.
4. Attribute equivalencies can be used to inform incentive design.



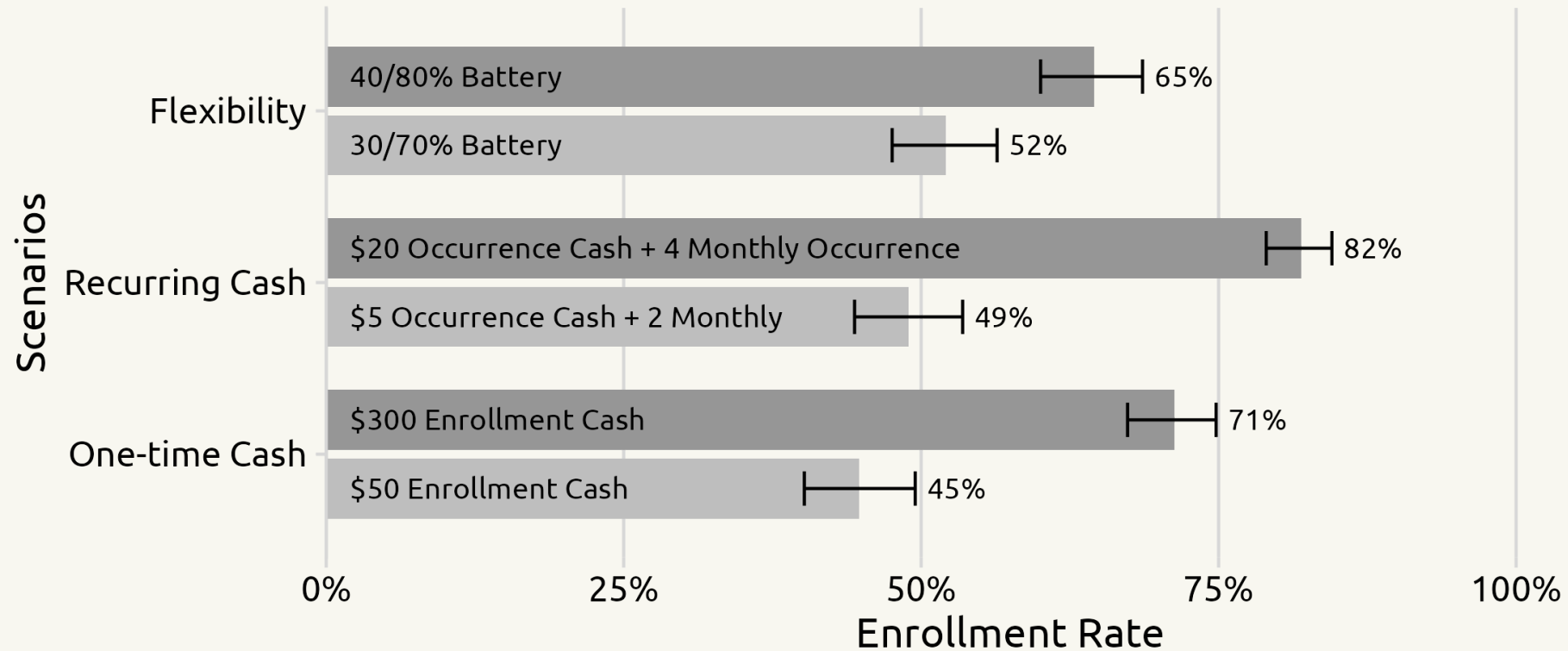
SMC Scenario Analysis



1. **Flexibility** is highly valued.
2. **Recurring** incentives are more important than one-time.
3. Payment alone is not enough.



V2G Scenario Analysis



1. Still, **recurring** incentives are more important than one-time.
2. But **flexibility** is not as important compared with SMC.
3. Owners are willing to leverage BEV as a source of income.



Smart Charging Enrollment Simulator

Smart Charging Enrollment Simulator
About
⚡ SMC (Supplier-Managed Charging)
🔌 V2G (Vehicle-to-Grid)

SMC Attributes:

Enrollment Cash (\$)

Monthly Cash (\$)

Override Allowance per Month

Minimum Threshold (%)

Guaranteed Threshold (%)

Reset

Predicted SMC Enrollment Probability:

31.9%

About SMC:

- SMC (Supplier-Managed Charging) allows the utility to monitor, manage, and restrict BEV charging to optimize energy flow during night charging at home.
- By participating in SMC, your BEV will be mostly charged during off-peak periods.

SMC Attributes Explained:

Attribute	Description
Enrollment Cash	The one-time payment you'll receive if you stay for at least 3 months.
Monthly Cash	The recurring monthly payment you'll receive if you don't exceed override allowance.
Override Allowance	The monthly frequency of override to normal charging, effective for 24hrs. If you exceed the limit, no monthly cash for this month.
Minimum Threshold	SMC won't be triggered below this threshold. In the survey it's converted to miles.
Guaranteed Threshold	SMC will give you this much of range by the morning (8 hrs' charging). In the survey it's converted to miles.



Contributions

1. First **large N** study of BEV owners' preferences for smart charging programs.
2. Quantified the **sensitivity** of BEV owners' preferences for smart charging features.
3. Introduced the concept of attribute **equivalencies** to inform incentive design.



Appendix - SMC Logit Model

$$u_j = \beta_1 x_j^{\text{enroll_cash}} + \beta_2 x_j^{\text{monthly_cash}} + \beta_3 \delta_j^{\text{override_allowed}} + \beta_4 x_j^{\text{num_overrides}} \\ + \beta_5 x_j^{\text{min_threshold}} + \beta_6 x_j^{\text{guaranteed_threshold}} + \beta_7 \delta_j^{\text{no_choice}} + \epsilon_j$$

Attribute	Coef.	Est.	SE	Level	Unit
Enrollment Cash	β_1	0.0031	0.0002	50, 100, 200, 300	USD
Monthly Cash	β_2	0.0623	0.0027	2, 5, 10, 15, 20	USD
Override Days	β_3	0.1010	0.0118	0, 1, 3, 5	Days
Override Flag	β_4	0.3622	0.0538	Yes, No	-
Minimum Threshold	β_5	0.0037	0.0021	20, 30, 40	%
Guaranteed Threshold	β_6	0.0362	0.0021	60, 70, 80	%
No Choice	β_7	3.0026	0.1779	-	-



Appendix - V2G Logit Model

$$u_j = \beta_1 x_j^{\text{enroll_cash}} + \beta_2 x_j^{\text{occur_cash}} + \beta_3 x_j^{\text{num_occurrences}} + \beta_4 x_j^{\text{lower_threshold}} + \beta_5 x_j^{\text{guaranteed_threshold}} + \beta_6 \delta_j^{\text{no_choice}} + \epsilon_j$$

Attribute	Coef.	Est.	SE	Level	Unit
Enrollment Cash	β_1	0.0045	0.0026	50, 100, 200, 300	USD
Occurrence Cash	β_2	0.0863	0.0040	2, 5, 10, 15, 20	USD
Monthly Occurrence	β_3	0.1305	0.0217	1, 2, 3, 4	Times
Lower Threshold	β_4	0.0237	0.0030	20, 30, 40	%
Guaranteed Threshold	β_5	0.0278	0.0030	60, 70, 80	%
No Choice	β_6	2.8759	0.2647	-	-



Reference List

- Huang, Bing, Aart Gerard Meijssen, Jan Anne Annema, and Zofia Lukszo. 2021. "Are Electric Vehicle Drivers Willing to Participate in Vehicle-to-Grid Contracts? A Context-Dependent Stated Choice Experiment." *Energy Policy* 156 (September): 112410. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.enpol.2021.112410>.
- Philip, Thara, and Jake Whitehead. 2024. "Consumer Preferences Towards Electric Vehicle Smart Charging Program Attributes: A Stated Preference Study." Rochester, NY. <https://doi.org/10.2139/ssrn.4812923>.
- Wong, Stephen D., Susan A. Shaheen, Elliot Martin, and Robert Uyeki. 2023. "Do Incentives Make a Difference? Understanding Smart Charging Program Adoption for Electric Vehicles." *Transportation Research Part C: Emerging Technologies* 151 (June): 104123. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.trc.2023.104123>.

